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From Being an Archive to Becoming an Achive

IASSIST 2015 June 2-4 2015

F3: Social Science Data Archives in Transition

Anne Sofie Fink, Ph.D., Head of Section

Danish Data Archive I National Archive of Denmark

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Outline

- Setting the scene
- The Danish model
- Data collections and user services
- A comparison of obligations, work tasks and services
- First challenges and obligations to be met
- To conclude…
- Your comments, advice and questions

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Setting the scene

- Since 1993 Danish Data Archive (DDA) has been part of the National Archive in Denmark.
- 1993-April 2014 DDA has been working as a (small) European style data archive
- May 2014: Implementation of a new organisational strategy and structure:
  - Specialised units for:
    - Acquisition
    - Curation
    - Dissemination
    - Software development
  - Working across public records/administrative data <u>and</u> research data

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The Danish model

Common strategies for administrative and research data across acquisition, preservation/curation, and dissemination.

Getting more effective by:

- Uniform work processes
- Uniform data formats
- Uniform user services

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DDA

– Dissemination of administrative registers and research data

Responsibilities:

- Dissemination of administrative registers and research data
- International corporation (about research data) incl. DDI Alliance
- Service provider for CESSDA

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New DDA

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About the collection of research data

App. 2000 studies:

Cross section surveys

Traditional surveys like attitudes and behaviour towards x, y, z … dating back to the 1960's

Time series

E.g. Danish Value Surveys (1980's), election studies (1970's), leisure studies (1960's)

Epidemiological data - Cohort and panels

E.g. Danish National Birth Cohort (start 1997), Database on ageing (start 1997, initial cohort born 1920-1945), Danish Child Cohort Study (initial cohort born 1968) and Danish Twin Studies

App. 80% of the studies used once or more

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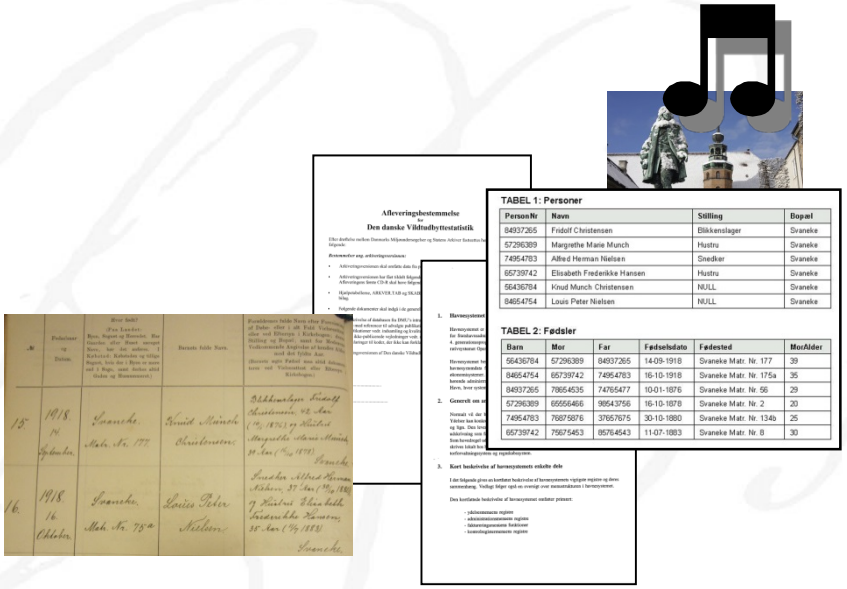
User service for Research Data

- **Integrated services** for social science and health science
- Rights to preserve **sensitive data** (incl. personal identification no.)
- Extensive **use of DDI-Lifecycle** for longterm preservation and dissemination
  - DDI-L based system support for dissemination processes
  - Documentation of longitudinal studies in the pipeline
- Use of **DOI** for study referencing

About the collection of administrative data

- Administrative data (public/official records) incl.register data and more…
- Selected for preservation by NA because of expected relevance for future (historic) research.
- Subjects: Anything(!)
- Sensitive information lots
- Usage pct.?



TABEL 1: Personer

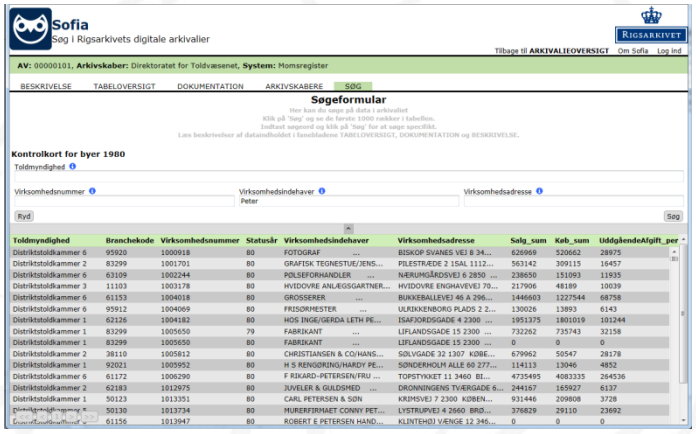
PersonNr	Navn	Stilling	Bopæl
84937265	Fridolf Christensen	Blikkenslager	Svaneke
57296389	Margrethe Marie Munch	Husfru	Svaneke
74954783	Alfred Herman Nielsen	Snedker	Svaneke
65739742	Elisabeth Frederikke Hansen	Husfru	Svaneke
56436784	Knud Munch Christensen	NULL	Svaneke
84654754	Louis Peter Nielsen	NULL	Svaneke

TABEL 2: Fødsler

Barn	Mor	Far	Fødselsdato	Fødested	MorAlder
56436784	57296389	84937265	14-09-1918	Svaneke Matr. Nr. 177	39
84654754	65739742	74954783	16-10-1918	Svaneke Matr. Nr. 175a	35
84937265	78654535	74765477	10-01-1876	Svaneke Matr. Nr. 56	29
57296389	65556466	98543756	16-10-1878	Svaneke Matr. Nr. 2	20
74954783	76875876	37657675	30-10-1880	Svaneke Matr. Nr. 134b	25
65739742	75675453	85764543	11-07-1883	Svaneke Matr. Nr. 8	30

User services for administrative data

- Search engine for the whole collection - Challenged by born digital resources
- Subject/key word-based search is a challenge
- Metadata on variable level
- Metadata on study level *to come*
- Dissemination service: Sofia
- Sofia used for look-up of single information elements for (by!) persons, organisations and public authorities



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Obligations and more

	National archive	Data archive
Time perspective for data dissemination	From future to eternity	From now to nearby future
Market for data /designated community	The national public Incl. public authorities	Research and Education
The collection	Public records/administrative data *(born digital)*	Research data
Standard for metadata	Nationally adapted standard for public records – SIARD-DK	International standard for metadata for structured data sets - DDI-Lifecycle
Experience in providing service for born digital material	Relatively short app. 10 years (first collections from 70's)	Relatively long since 1973 (data sets from mid 60's)
Data ownership	Materials owned by NA	Materials owned by depositors (!)

Work processes and services

	National archive	Data archive
User service	Search Access to single information by look-up provided by personnel (due to legislation) Self service (closed for the time being)	Search Download/forwarding (by email) of data files Referencing of data, PID/DOI
Dissemination format (DIP)	Spread sheet/word	Statistical format SPSS, SAS, Stata eller csv
Sensitive information	Many data sets contains sensitive information (manually to be checked)	Several data sets with sensitive information Anonymous data sets created by separating variables with sensitive information from
Open access to data	By legislation: 20 years for non-sensitive information 75 years for sensitive information Possibility for access by application to the data protection agency and the NA	By agreement with depositor: App. 50 app. open access Possibility for access by application to the data protection agency

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First challenges (and risks) to be met for DDA

- Easy search for the whole collection of data
  - Common formats for metadata – or make believe
  - Common user services for same use cases
    - Non professional users (e.g. geneology, local community history, documentation of administrative practice)
    - Researchers and students
  - Separation of sensitive information
  - Anonymised data sets
  - Coordination of access restrictions implied by the data ownership, data depositors, data access boards, the data protection agency
- Self service – yes… but?

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And obligations to be met for the new DDA

- ‘Fitting in’
- Legislation and national requirements
  - Access
  - Price model
- Serviceprovider for CESSDA ERIC
  - Data Seal of Approval as a data archive
  - DDI compliant
  - Part of common user services and initiatives
- Project partner in international and national contexts

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To conclude…

- From being a (data) archive to becoming a (national) archive
- Challenges and risks ahead
- More gains than losses

- Now we need to go into action mode
- Getting the best of two archives into one archive

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THE NATIONAL ARCHIVE OF DENMARK

DDA *inside*

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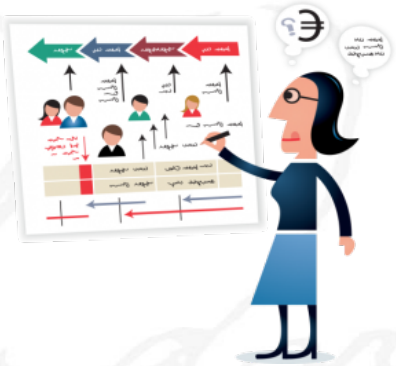
Your comments, advice and questions (to be filled in):



Thank you!

Contact information: Anne Sofie Fink, asf@dda.dk